



Sports Ministry forms 10-member Task Force to bring F1 back to India



The Sports Ministry's efforts to bring back Formula One to India and to revive and develop motorsports in the country has taken another step forward with the constitution of a 10-member Task Force to look into the matter.

The Task Force, to be headed by NITI Aayog Programme Director Yugal Kishore Joshi, will also have joint secretary Kunal, joint secretaries from the ministries of commerce and tourism, representatives from the Buddh and Madras International Circuits, State government representatives from UP and Maharashtra, FMSCI representative and a technical expert.

"While the main objective of the Task Force will be to make a comprehensive assessment of the existing motorsports ecosystem in the country, its main challenge would be to find ways to resolve the taxation-related issues that led to Formula One's past departures from the country," sports minister Mansukh Madaviya said.

The terms of reference of the Task Force include identifying policy interventions for the sustainable growth of motorsports in India including infrastructure and operational needs, assess the economic, tourism and investment benefits accruing from hosting major events and explore the feasibility of hosting an F1 Grand Prix in 2028.

UTHRA GANESAN

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 The Asian Cadet Cup, a major international fencing championship featuring young athletes from across the continent, will be held in Chennai from November 20-23. The tournament will feature more than 500 athletes, coaches, officials and technical personnel from over 30 countries. The competitions will be held across three fencing weapons — Epee, Foil, and Sabre. The championship is being organised by the Fencing Association of India under the aegis of the Asian Fencing Confederation, with the support of the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, the Sports Authority of India and the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu. "This event will provide our young fencers and athletes from across Asia with valuable international exposure," FAI secretary general Rajeev Mehta said in a release.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 Sahal Abdul Samad scored a brace as a 10-man Mohun Bagan Super Giant beat Mohammedan Sporting 3-2 at the Barasat Stadium to win the Calcutta Football League (CFL) title after eight years. Durand Cup champion East Bengal outplayed Coal India 7-0 on its own ground to finish as the runner-up with five points, two less than Bagan, in the Super Six stage.

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